

In other words, the knowledge of any one of these factors can help predict or better estimate your retirement mortality rate, sometimes by a factor of 2-to-1.

As just one example of these factors, the Max Planck Institute in Germany has recently confirmed, using a large database of actual mortality experience, that although males in general don't live as long as females, interestingly, married males tend to live longer than single males. But oddly enough marriage is not associated with greater longevity for females. For them, being widowed, single, or divorced is a factor associated with reduced mortality. The findings are summarized in Table 7.3 and are quite controversial, besides being somewhat amusing. Why is marriage "better" for males' longevity compared to females' longevity? Does this study apply broadly across different demographic groups? The research is still ongoing.

**TABLE 7.3 What Reduces Your Retirement Mortality Rates
(Beyond the Obvious)?**

All Genders	Parents Lived Beyond Age 75 Mentally Active During Retirement
Male Only	Being Married
Female Only	Being Single, Divorced, or Widowed

Source: Rasmus Hoffmann, "Do Socioeconomic Mortality Differences Decrease with Rising Age?", *Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research*, 2005.

Along the same lines, Table 7.4 displays data showing that life expectancy at age 70 is related to one's income level. Falling within the 80th versus the 20th income percentile can mean the difference of three years in life expectancy for a healthy male or female. The wealthy are healthier.

TABLE 7.4 Health and Wealth: Life Expectancy at Age 70

Income Percentile	Healthy Male	Healthy Female
20th	78.2 yrs	83.8 yrs
40th	79.1 yrs	84.8 yrs
60th	80.1 yrs	85.9 yrs
80th	81.2 yrs	87.0 yrs

Source: Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, WP 2005-13 (De Nardi, French, and Jones).